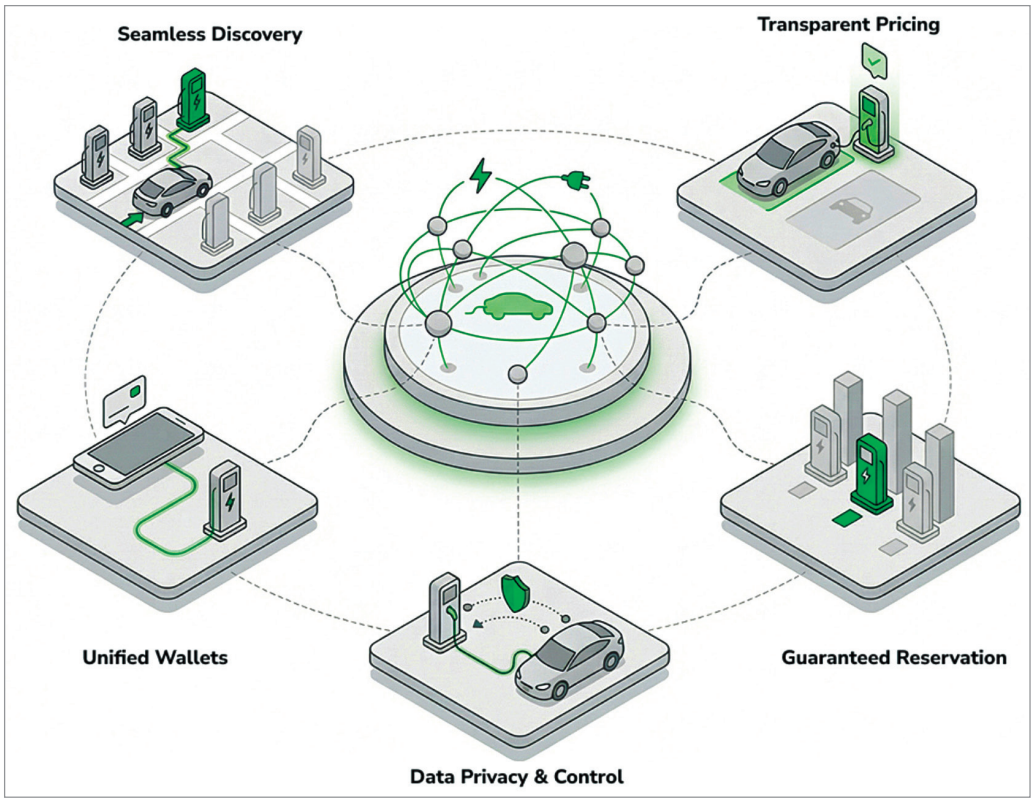


How EV users benefit from Unified Bharat e-Charge (UBC)

The key change for users is interoperability. Different charging operators can continue running their own networks, while UBC provides a common layer through which users can seamlessly discover and access those chargers.

From rollout to real-world access

UBC went live on August 15, 2026, with the initial consumer rollout debuting through the BHIM app. EV users can easily discover participating UBC-enabled chargers, scan the QR code at the charging point, and pay directly from their bank account using UPI. The initial rollout covers participating charging points across cities and national highways.

More than 10,000 chargers have already been integrated into the UBC network. Pulse Energy, one of UBC's first certified technology enablers, announced that it had successfully integrated these chargers into the UBC network ahead of the national rollout. The company says it works with more than 100 charge-point operator partners and is helping operators connect their existing charging infrastructure to UBC without replacing their hardware or brands. This highlights how interoperability connects existing assets without requiring operators to replace their hardware.

While UBC material describes the chargers as integrated into its network, this figure specifically represents chargers connected via Pulse Energy and its operator partners; it should not be interpreted as 10,000 chargers independently operated by UBC.

What remains less clear from the public information is the exact number of operators and chargers that are actively visible and usable to consumers inside the BHIM app at any given moment, as well as a verified city-by-city or highway-by-highway coverage list. While the public rollout confirms that participating chargers are steadily being added across urban areas and highways, an independently verified real-time count or a detailed live coverage map has not yet been provided.

What could UBC change for the EV charging industry?

UBC could reduce the dependence on

The forces behind UBC

UBC brings together government agencies, technology providers, payment platforms, and charging operators, with each playing a different role in the system.

- ***Ministry of Heavy Industries (MHI).*** Establishes the government framework for EV charging under the PM E-DRIVE scheme, including the proposed National Unified Hub for public charging stations
- ***Bharat Heavy Electricals Limited (BHEL).*** Serves as the Project Implementation Agency for EV public charging infrastructure under PM E-DRIVE and is responsible for implementing the National Unified Hub and its mobile application
- ***NPCI BHIM Services Ltd (NBSL).*** Works with BHEL on the National Unified Hub and mobile application, connecting the platform with the BHIM and UPI payment ecosystem
- ***Beckn Protocol.*** Provides the open-network technology that enables different participants to exchange information and interact across networks without relying on a single proprietary platform
- ***Network for Humanity (NFH).*** Has been involved in developing the digital public infrastructure based on the Beckn Protocol
- ***Charging point operators (CPOs).*** Connect their existing charging infrastructure to the UBC ecosystem, allowing their chargers to become discoverable and accessible through participating consumer platforms